

ISU Figure Skating Protocol Symbols Cheat Sheet

Jump Symbols & Rotation Calls

Symbol	Meaning	Explanation
3Lz+3T	Triple Lutz + Triple Toe Loop	A jump combination containing a triple Lutz immediately followed by a triple Toe Loop.
3F	Triple Flip	A triple Flip jump.
2A	Double Axel	A double Axel jump.
+SEQ	Jump Sequence	Indicates a jump sequence instead of a direct combination.
+COMBO	Combination	The jump is connected directly to another jump.
q	Quarter under-rotation	The jump landed about 1/4 turn short. Full base value is kept, but GOE is reduced.
<	Under-rotated	The jump is more than 1/4 short but less than 1/2 short. Base value is reduced.
<<	Downgraded	The jump is short by 1/2 rotation or more. Evaluated as a jump with one less rotation.
!	Attention on edge	Minor edge issue on takeoff. Usually applies to Flip or Lutz jumps.
e	Wrong edge	Clear incorrect edge takeoff on Flip or Lutz. Receives GOE reduction.
x	Bonus section	Jump performed in the second half of the program and receives a bonus multiplier.
REP	Repeated jump	A repeated jump violating repetition rules. Reduced value.
F	Fall	Skater fell on the element. GOE reduction and fall deduction applied.
*	Invalid element	Element receives no value due to rule violation.

Spin Symbols

Symbol	Meaning	Explanation
CCoSp	Change Combination Spin	Spin with multiple positions and foot changes.

Symbol	Meaning	Explanation
FCCoSp	Flying Change Combination Spin	Flying entry plus combination spin with foot change.
FCSp	Flying Camel Spin	Flying entry directly into camel position.
LSp	Layback Spin	Layback spin variation, usually performed by women.
SSp	Sit Spin	Spin performed in sit position.
USp	Upright Spin	Upright position spin.
Biellmann	Biellmann Position	Overhead leg-hold variation often used in spins.
pB	Poor basic position	Position did not meet requirements clearly.
V	Level feature missing	Spin or step sequence missing required feature.
B	Base level	Lowest level awarded.
1 / 2 / 3 / 4	Level of difficulty	Higher number means more difficult features completed.

Step Sequences & Choreographic Elements

Symbol	Meaning	Explanation
StSq	Step Sequence	Technical footwork sequence.
ChSq	Choreographic Sequence	Artistic choreographic sequence in free skate.
ChSp	Choreographic Spin	Choreographic spin element.
Tw	Twizzles	Traveling one-foot turns, common in ice dance.
MiSt	Midline Step Sequence	Ice dance step sequence along center line.
DiSt	Diagonal Step Sequence	Diagonal pattern step sequence.
SLi	Slide Lift	Type of lift in ice dance.

Common Jump Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Jump
T	Toe Loop

Abbreviation	Jump
S	Salchow
Lo	Loop
F	Flip
Lz	Lutz
A	Axel

Example Protocol Interpretations

Example	Meaning
3Lz+3Tq	Triple Lutz + Triple Toe Loop, with the Toe Loop quarter under-rotated.
3F<	Triple Flip under-rotated.
3Lz<<	Triple Lutz downgraded to double Lutz value.
2A+SEQ	Double Axel performed in a jump sequence.
CCoSp4	Change Combination Spin Level 4.
StSq3	Step Sequence Level 3.
3Lze	Triple Lutz with wrong edge takeoff.

ISU Rotation Rule Summary

Call	Rotation Status	Effect
Clean	Fully rotated	Full value
q	About 1/4 short	Full base value, GOE reduction
<	More than 1/4 short	Reduced base value
<<	1/2 short or more	Downgraded to lower rotation jump

Sources

This cheat sheet was compiled using ISU judging references and ISU-related figure skating protocol guides.

Key references:

- ISU Communications & Scale of Values
- ISU Judging System documentation
- So You Want To Watch Figure Skating guides

Important references discussing q / < / << calls:

- ISU Communication 2623
- ISU Judging System explanations
- Technical protocol interpretation guides

References consulted online:

- <https://www.isu.org/figure-skating-rules/>
- <https://www.soyouwanttowatchfs.com/>